Night Infrared Close Air Support Brevity Codes

Call	Meaning and Techniques
SPARKLE	Mark/marking target by infrared (IR) pointer. (Joint terminal attack controller [JTAC]/forward air controller (airborne) [FAC{A}]) marks the target with an IR pointer. Can be initiated by JTAC/FAC(A) or aircrew. Proper aircrew response is CONTACT SPARKLE or NO JOY.)
SNAKE	Oscillate an IR pointer in a figure eight about a target. (Call made by exception for the JTAC/FAC(A) to jiggle the IR beam on the target. This aids in looking at the proper IR pointer and can aid in the acquisition of the IR energy. Proper aircrew response is CONTACT SPARKLE, STEADY, or NO JOY.)
PULSE	Illuminate/illuminating a position with flashing IR energy. (JTAC/FAC[A] uses pulse mode available on some IR pointers. Can be initiated by JTAC/FAC[A] or aircrew. May be used by JTAC/FAC[A] to emphasize that an enemy position is being illuminated by flashing IR energy, which is often used to identify friendly positions. Proper aircrew response is CONTACT SPARKLE, STEADY, or NO JOY.)
STEADY	Stop oscillation of IR pointer. (JTAC/FAC[A] steadies the beam after a SNAKE or PULSE call. This can aid in verifying that the aircrew is looking at the proper IR pointer.)
CEASE SPARKLE	Discontinue sparkle activity. (JTAC/FAC[A] turns the beam off. This can aid in verifying that the aircrew is looking at the proper IR pointer, especially if followed with a SPARKLE call.)
ROPE	Circling an IR pointer around an aircraft to help the aircraft identify the friendly ground position. **Warning:** This technique may cause permanent blindness in aircrew. **Caution:** This technique may damage night-vision devices.
CONTACT SPARKLE	Call acknowledging the sighting (of the non-friendly end) of a specified reference point (either visually or via sensor). After the SPARKLE call is made, the close air support aircraft should respond with NO JOY or SNAKE until the friendly position can be identified. Then, once the aircrew sees the IR energy and is able to discern between the friendly and target end of the pointer, a VISUAL and CONTACT SPARKLE call may be made.
MATCH SPARKLE	Overlay requested target designator type. (Directive term for a second party to overlay an IR mark on an existing mark.)

Note:

ROPE is not recommended for rotary-wing aircraft. The brevity codes listed in this figure amplify the IR communications in Army Techniques Publication 1-02.1/Marine Corps Reference Publication 3-30B.1/Navy Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 6-02.1/Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-2.5, *Multi-Service Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures for Multi-Service Brevity Codes.*

Standard Marking Brevity Codes

BLIND	No visual contact with FRIENDLY aircraft, ship, or ground position. Opposite of VISUAL.
VISUAL	Sighting of a FRIENDLY aircraft, ground position, or ship. Opposite of BLIND.
CONTACT	Acknowledges sighting of a specified reference point (either visually or via sensor).
(Target/Object) CAPTURED	Specified surface target or object has been acquired and is being tracked with an onboard sensor.
LOOKING	Aircrew does not have the ground object, reference point, or target in sight. Opposite of CONTACT.
TALLY	Sighting of a target, nonfriendly aircraft, or enemy position. Opposite of NO JOY.
NO JOY	Aircrew does not have visual contact with the TARGET/BANDIT. Opposite of TALLY.

Standard Laser Brevity Codes

Call	Meaning
TEN SECONDS	Standby for LASER ON call in approximately 10 seconds.
LASER ON	Start/acknowledge laser designation.
SHIFT (Direction/TN)	Shift laser/infrared/radar/device energy/aimpoint. Note: Can be used to shift from the offset position onto the target. Also used during multi-aircraft attack to shift laser energy or target assignments.
SPOT	Acquisition of laser designation.
CEASE LASER	Discontinue lasing.
DEADEYE	Laser designator system inoperative.
NEGATIVE LASER	Laser energy has not been acquired.
LASING	The speaker is firing the laser.
STARE (with laser code and reference point)	Cue the laser spot search/tracker function on the specified laser code in relation to the specified reference point. Reference point may include the following: steerpoint, geographic reference, bearing and range, or data link point.

Summary of Types of Terminal Attack Control and Methods of Attack

Type of TAC	JTAC/FAC(A) Requirement
Type 1	JTAC/FAC(A) will visually acquire the target and the attacking aircraft during the terminal phase of an attack, prior to weapons release, and assess attack aircraft geometry while maintaining control of individual attacks.
Type 2	JTAC/FAC(A) will utilize other measures to mitigate risk while maintaining control of individual attacks.
Type 3	JTAC/FAC(A) will utilize other measures to mitigate risk and assesses that the measures in place will allow multiple attacks within the same engagement.

Method of Attack	Requirement
BOT	Aircraft/aircrew will acquire the target or intended aimpoint using the best method available.
BOC	Aircraft/aircrew will employ weapons on the specified coordinates given in the close air support brief.

Legend

BOC	bomb on coordinate	JTAC	joint terminal attack controller
BOT	bomb on target	TAC	terminal attack control
FAC(A)	forward air controller (airborne)		

Close Air Support Check-In Briefing

Close Air Support Check-In Briefing

(Aircraft transmits to controller)
Aircraft "_____," this is "_____" (e.g., "Heartless 52, this is Rumble 31")
(JTAC C/S) (Aircraft C/S)

1. Mission Number _____. (e.g., "Mission number 1541")
   (ATO assigned MSN #)
2. Number and type of aircraft: _____. (e.g., "2 by F/A-18C")
3. Position and altitude: _____. (e.g., "Currently 20 nm north of Ford, block 20-21")
4. Ordnance: _____. (e.g., "500 rounds of 20mm, 1 by GBU-12, 1 by GBU-38 each aircraft, laser codes Rumble 31-1688, Rumble 32-1731, instantaneous and delayed fuzing for GBU-12s and GBU-38s")
5. Playtime or Time on Station: _____. (e.g., "We have 25 minutes time on station")
6. Capabilities:
   FAC(A), Type of Sensors, Link-16, VDL code, SITREPs on board, map version or GRGs, UAS Lost Link Procedures/Route: (e.g., "Rumble 31 is FAC(A)-capable. Both aircraft are ATFLIR, and CAT II coordinate generation capable. Timber Sweet, Rumble 31 VDL code 4927. Rumble 32, VDL code 4977. We have SITREP C and micro-GRG 15-17 onboard.")
7. Abort code: _____. (e.g., "Abort code none, Ready to copy your updated SITREP.")

Legend

ATFLIR	advanced targeting forward-looking infrared	mm	milimeter
ATO	air tasking order	MSN	mission number
CAT	category	nm	nautical mile
C/S	call sign	SITREP	situation report
FAC(A)	forward air controller (airborne)	UAS	unmanned aircraft system
GRG	gridded reference graphic	VDL	video downlink
JTAC	joint terminal attack controller		

Special Operations Forces Gunship Call for Fire*

Special Operations Forces Gunship Call for Fire

1. Observer and Warning Order
"_____, this is _____, fire mission, over"
(aircraft call sign) (observer call sign)

2. Friendly Location and Mark
"My position _____, marked by _____"
(TRP, grid, etc.) (strobe, beacon, IR strobe, etc.)

3. Target Location
"Target Location _____."
(bearing (magnetic) and range (meters), TRP, grid, etc.)

4. Target Description and Mark
"_____, marked by _____."
(target description) (IR pointer, tracer, etc.)

5. Remarks:
"_____, over."
(threats, danger close clearance, restriction, at my command, TOT, etc.)

Notes:

1. Clearance. If airspace has been cleared between the employing aircraft and the target, transmission of this brief is clearance to fire unless "danger close," "at my command," or an additional method of control is stated.

2. Danger Close. For danger close fire, the observer or commander must accept responsibility for increased risk. State "cleared danger close" in line 5 and pass the initials of the on-scene ground commander. This clearance may be preplanned.

3. At My Command. For positive control of the aircraft, state "at my command" on line 5. The aircraft will call "ready to fire," when ready.

4. For synchronization of fires, methods of fire and control may be included in line 5. Reference Table 5, "Methods of Fire and Control," for additional measures.

*Also used for Army attack aviation request.

Legend

IR	infrared	TRP	target reference point
TOT	time to target		

Rotary-Wing Close Air Support 5-Line Brief

Rotary-Wing Close Air Support 5-Line Brief

Do not transmit line numbers. Units of measure are standard unless briefed. Restrictions are mandatory readback (*). JTAC/FAC(A) may request additional readback.

1. Observer / Warning Order / Game Plan
"_____, _____ 5-line,
(aircraft call sign) (JTAC/FAC(A) call sign)
Type (1, 2, or 3) control, MOA (BOC or BOT), (ordnance requested)."

2. Friendly location / mark
"My position_____, marked by _____"
(target reference point, grid, etc.) (VS-17, beacon, IR strobe, etc.)

3. Target location
"Target location, _____"
(magnetic bearing and range in meters, target reference point, grid, etc.)

4. Target description / mark
"_____, marked by _____"
(target description) (IR, tracer, etc.)

5. Remarks and *Restrictions
Laser-to-target line (LTL) / pointer-to-target line (PTL)
Desired type and number of ordnance or weapons effects (if not previously coordinated)
Surface-to-air threat, location, and type of SEAD
Additional remarks (e.g., gun-target line (GTL), weather, hazards, friendly marks)
Additional calls requested
*Final attack headings or attack direction
*Airspace coordination areas (ACA)s
*Danger close and initials (if applicable)
*Time on target (TOT) / time to target (TTT)
*Post-launch abort restrictions (if applicable).
*Approval out of battle position

Note:
The rotary-wing CAS 5-Line should be passed as one transmission. If the restrictions portion is lengthy, it may be a separate transmission.

Legend

BOC	bomb on coordinate	IR	infrared
BOT	bomb on target	JTAC	joint terminal attack controller
CAS	close air support	MOA	method of attack
FAC(A)	forward air controller(airborne)	SEAD	suppression of enemy air defenses

Situation Update Example 1

Line	Close Air Support (CAS) Situation Update	Battlefield Handover (BHO)
Threat	• General locations of surface-to-air threats not already provided. • Time of last-observed surface-to-air fires.	
Targets	• General enemy disposition. • Avoid listing of grids. Targets locations will be addressed in a CAS brief.	• General enemy disposition. • Ground commander's targeting priority list. • Target location grids (may require breaking up the transmission). • Ground commander's attack guidance matrix.
Friendly	• General friendly situation and scheme of maneuver. • Use geographic references, phase lines, checkpoints, etc. The technique is to use general terms: "all friendlies are east of the 94 easting." • Avoid passing friendly grids. If needed, use no more than 6 digits. • Include all friendly forces that may be factors during time on station (TOS), not just the joint terminal attack controller (JTAC). • All CAS assets, ordnance, and TOS remaining for BHO.	
Artillery	• Indirect fire assets that could be factors during TOS, may include the general direction of fire.	• Include the firing unit's location, call sign, frequency, and status.
Clearance Authority	• Omit it if the speaker has control. • Clarify roles if there are multiple voices on tactical air direction. For example, "Savage 13 has control and is located in the combat operations center. My JFO call sign, E4B, is located with Charlie company and is up this net." • Determine who has which elements of brief, stack, mark, and control. • Pass a plan for approving fires for BHO.	
Ordnance	• Determine the expected ordnance required to create the ground commander's desired effects. • Provide any restrictions to ordnance, such as no cluster bomb units or low collateral damage bombs only.	
Remarks and Restrictions	May include the following: • Hazards - towers, min safe altitude, weather (including surface winds). • JTAC capabilities (e.g., laser, infrared, video downlink). • Intent for aircraft (e.g., CAS, multisensory imagery reconnaissance). • Additional radio calls required by terminal attack controller (e.g., initial point inbound).	May include the following: • Updates to preplanned airspace coordinating measures, fire support coordination measures, and maneuver control measures. • Provide a positive passing of the appropriate elements of brief, stack, mark, and control. • Hazards - towers, min safe altitude, weather (including surface winds).

An Example of Situation Update 1:

CAS: "The current surface-to-air threat is an SA-6 at KJ 123 456, just west of MSR Tampa. The target is a light armored company attempting to flank us to the north and two companies dug in 3 kilometers to our west, break."

"Friendlies are two companies in the vicinity of OP 2, one on the high ground and the other in a blocking position to the east. I am with the company on the high ground. There is also a recon team at the northwest tip of Black Mountain, artillery is located at Firebase 5E, firing generally west, break."

"Savage 13 has control. Plan on using your GP bombs to disrupt the light armor. Winds on the deck are 10-knots out of the west. Savage is laser and IR capable, advise when ready for game plan."

Situation Update Example 2

Line	Close Air Support (CAS) Situation Update	Battlefield Handover (BHO)
Threat	• General locations of surface-to-air threats not already provided. • Time of last observed surface-to-air fires.	
Enemy Situation	• General enemy disposition. • Avoid listing of grids. Targets locations will be addressed in a CAS brief.	• General enemy disposition. • Ground commander's targeting priority list. • Target location grids (may require breaking up the transmission). • Ground commander's attack guidance matrix.
Friendly	• General friendly situation and scheme of maneuver. • Use geographic references, phase lines, checkpoints, etc. The technique is to use general terms: "all friendlies are east of the 94 easting." • Avoid passing friendly grids. If needed, use no more than 6 digits. • Include all friendlies that may be factors during time on station (TOS), not just the joint terminal attack controller (JTAC). • All CAS assets, ordnance, and TOS remaining for BHO.	
Artillery	• Indirect fire assets that could be factors during TOS, may include the general direction of fire.	• Determine the firing unit's location, call sign, frequency, and status.
Clearance Authority	• Omit it if the speaker has control. • Clarify roles if there are multiple voices on tactical air direction. For example, "Broadsword 11 has control and is located in the combat operations center. My JFO call sign, Mustang, is located with Charlie company and is up this net." • Determine who has authority for brief, stack, mark, and control. • Pass a plan for approving fires for BHO.	
Hazards	• Towers, min safe altitude, weather (including surface winds).	
Remarks and Restrictions	May include the following: • JTAC capabilities (e.g., laser, infrared, video downlink). • Factor airspace coordinating measure (ACM)/fire support coordination measure (FSCM). • Intent for aircraft (e.g., CAS, multisensory imagery reconnaissance). • Additional radio calls required by terminal attack controller (e.g., initial point inbound).	May include the following: • Updates to preplanned ACM/FSCM/maneuver control measure. • Provide a positive passing of the appropriate elements of brief, stack, mark, and control during BHO.

An Example of Situation Update 2:

JTAC or FAC(A) [forward air controller {airborne}] :

"The current surface-to-air threat is an unlocated ZSU 23-4, last seen west of MSR 5. The enemy situation is a light armored company attempting to flank us to the north and two companies dug in three klicks to our west, break."

"Friendlies are two companies in the vicinity of OP 2, one on the high ground and the other in a blocking position to the east. I am with the company on the high ground. There is also a STA team at the northwest tip of Blue Mountain; 81 mm mortars are south of OP 2, firing generally northwest, break."

"Winds on the deck are 15–20 knots out of the northwest, I have a videoscout, but no laser. Request 'IN' with heading for all type 2 controls. I plan on using you to disrupt the light armor, advise when ready for game plan."

Game Plan and 9-Line Close Air Support Briefing Format

Game Plan and 9-Line Close Air Support Briefing Format

Do not transmit the numbers. Units of measure are standard unless briefed.

Lines 4, 6, and any restrictions are mandatory readbacks. The joint terminal attack controller (JTAC) may request an additional readback.

JTAC: "_____, advise when ready for game plan."

JTAC: "Type (1, 2, 3) control (method of attack, effects desired or ordnance, interval). Advise when ready for 9-line."

1. Initial Point / Battle Position: "_____"
2. Heading: "_____"
   (degrees magnetic, initial point or battle position-to-target)
   Offset: "_____."
   (left or right, when requested)
3. Distance: "_____"
   (initial point-to-target in nautical miles, battle position-to-target in meters)
4. Target elevation: "_____"
   (in feet, mean sea level)
5. Target description: "_____"
6. Target location: "_____"
   (latitude and longitude or grid coordinates, or offsets or visual)
7. Type mark / terminal guidance : "_____"
   (description of the mark, if laser handoff, call sign of lasing platform and code)
8. Location of friendlies: "_____"
   (from target, cardinal direction and distance in meters)
   Position marked by: "_____"
9. "Egress _____."

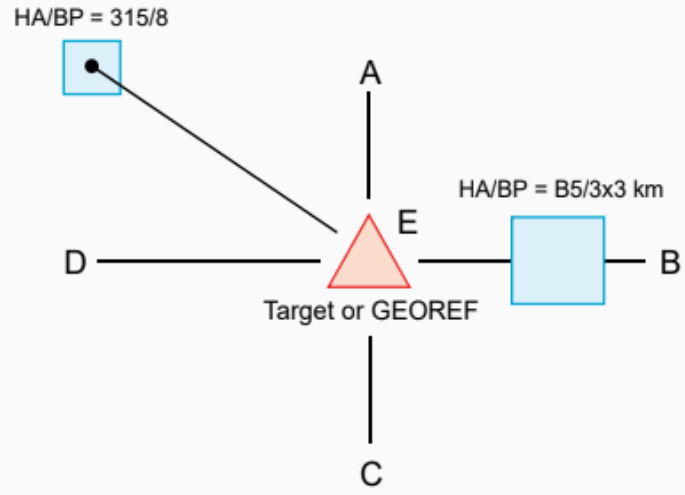
Remarks and *Restrictions:

- Laser-to-target line (LTL) / pointer-to-target line (PTL)
- Desired type and number of ordnance or weapons effects (if not previously coordinated).
- Surface-to-air threat, location, and type of suppression of enemy air defense (SEAD).
- Additional remarks (e.g., gun-to-target line, weather, hazards, friendly marks).
- Additional calls requested.
- *Final attack headings or attack direction.
- *Airspace coordination areas (ACAs).
- *Danger close and initials (if applicable).
- *Time on target (TOT) / time to target (TTT).
- *Post launch abort restrictions (if applicable).
- *Approval out of battle position for rotary-wing aircraft.

Legend

BP	battle position	IP	initial point

Rotary-Wing Keyhole Example



Legend

BP	battle position	HA	holding area
GEOREF	geographic reference	km	kilometer

9 LINE MEDEVAC REQUEST Worksheet

LINE	EXPLANATION
1	**LOCATION**
2	**CALL SIGN / FREQUENCY**
3	**# PXT BY PRECEDENCE**
	A - URGENT (w/in 2 hrs)
	B - URGENT SURG (w/in 2 hrs)
	C - PRIORITY (w/in 4 hrs)
	D - ROUTINE (w/in 24 hrs)
4	**SPECIAL EQPT**
	A - NONE
	B - HOIST
	C - EXTRACTION EQPT
	D - VENTILATOR
5	**# PXT BY TYPE**
	L + # = litter
	A + # = ambulatory
6	**WARTIME (SECURITY OF PZ)**
	N - NO ENEMY TROOPS
	P - POSSIBLE ENEMY
	E - ENEMY IN AREA, PROCEED WITH CAUTION
	X - ENEMY IN AREA, ARMED ESCORT REQUIRED
6	**PEACETIME (NUMBER & TYPE OF WOUNDED)**
7	**METHOD OF MARKING PZ**
	A - PANELS (color)
	B - PYROTECHNIC SIGNAL
	C - SMOKE SIGNAL
	D - NONE
	E - OTHER
8	**PXT NATIONALITY AND STATUS**
	A - US MILITARY
	B - US CIVILIAN
	C - NON-US MILITARY
	D - NON-US CIVILIAN
	E - EPW
9	**WARTIME (NBC CONTAMINATION)**
	N - NUCLEAR
	B - BIOLOGICAL
	C - CHEMICAL